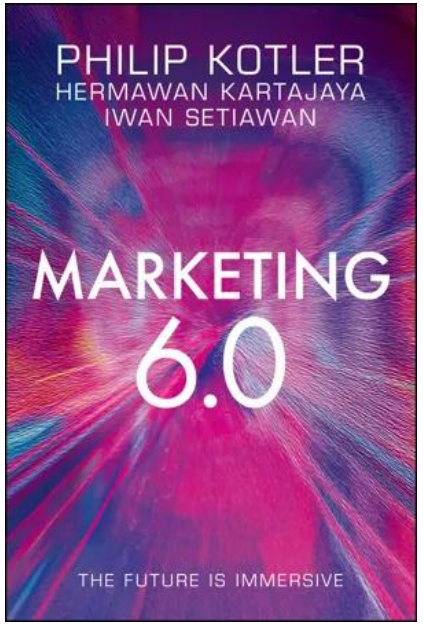
IT3120- Modern Enterprise Management
Introduction to Marketing

Marketing strategy, market research, product management, Digital marketing, Brand management, Customer relationship management



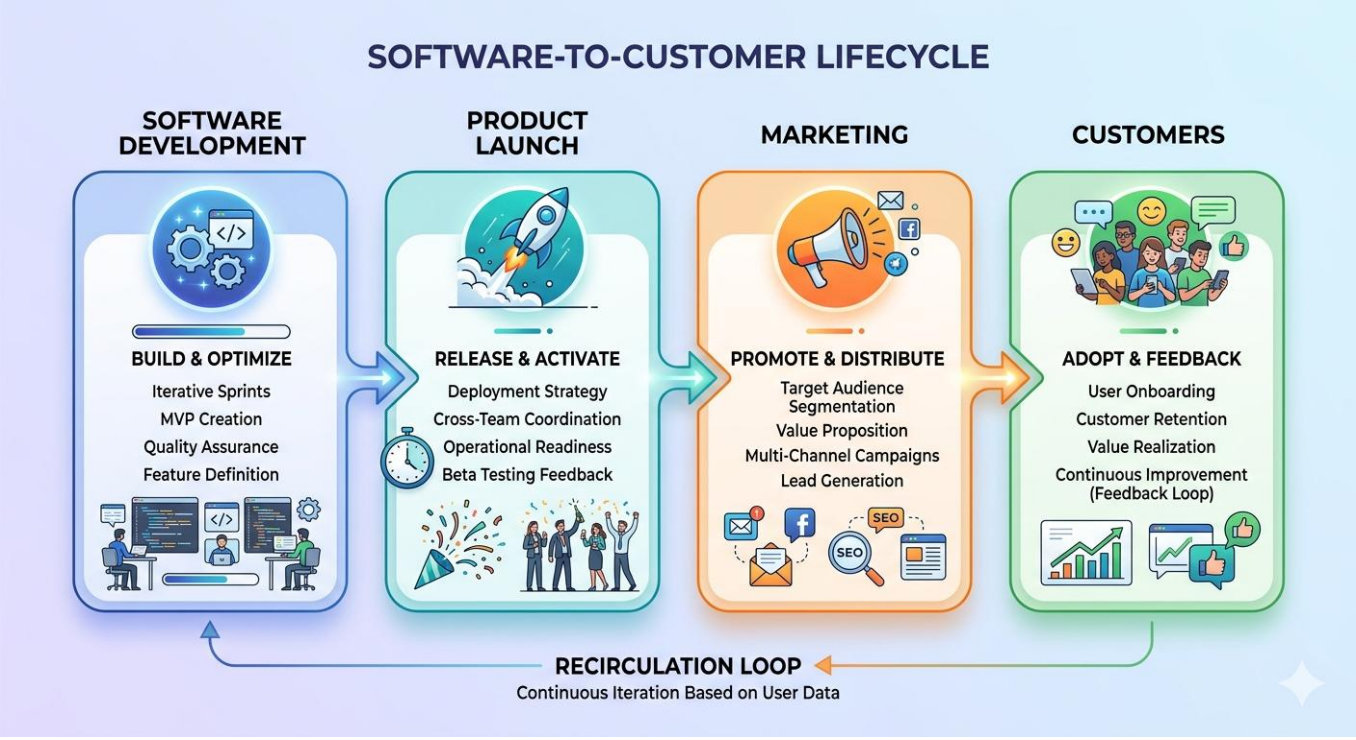
Lecture Objectives

- Understand modern marketing concepts
- Apply marketing strategy in digital environments
- Analyze customer data for decision-making
- Connect IT skills with marketing applications

Why Computing Students Learn Marketing?

- Technology does not sell itself.
- Most software products fail due to poor market fit. E.g. Many student-developed mobile apps never gain users because marketing is ignored.
- Tech Entrepreneurship.

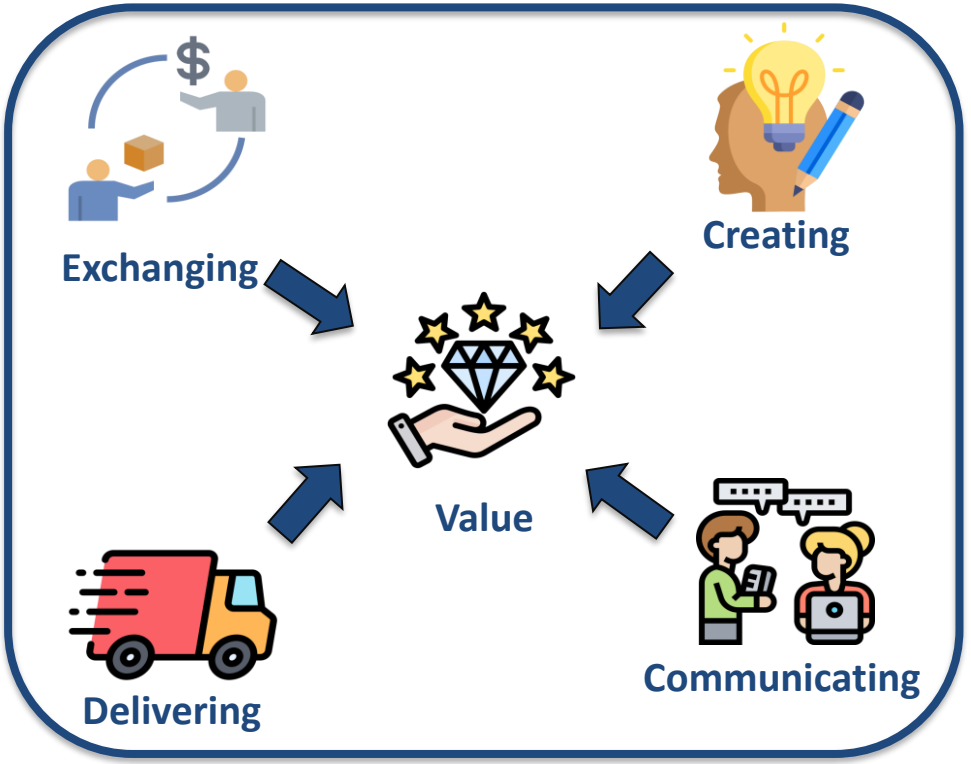




What is Marketing?

A **human-centric** and **technology-enabled** process of **creating, communicating, delivering** and **exchanging value** to customers while building meaningful and **long-term relationships**.

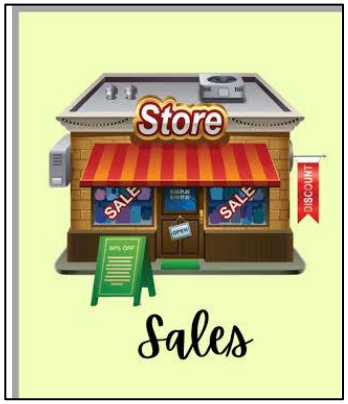
- Meeting **customer needs and wants**.
- Building **long-term customer relationships**.
- **Creation of value for customers and capturing value in return.**



Marketing vs Selling

- Selling is the immediate, transactional process of persuading a specificcustomer to buy the product

- Marketing focuses on identifying consumer needs and building long-term brand loyalty. It is a strategic process involving market research, advertising, and product development.

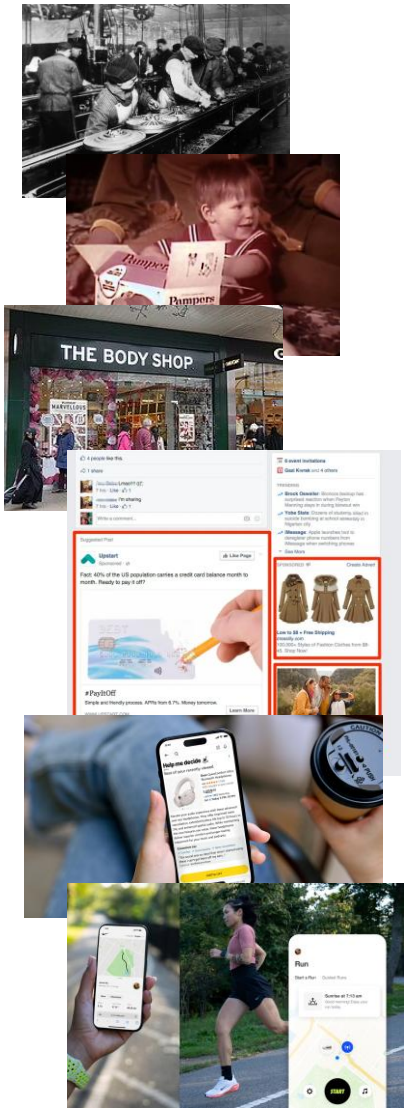


Marketing	Selling
Customer Focus	Product Focus
Long-Term	Short-Term
Relationship	Transaction



Evolution of Marketing

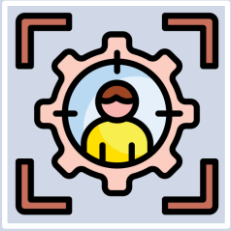
Era	Main Focus	Key Shift
Before 1960s	Product-Centric	Efficiency & production
1960s–1980s	Customer-Centric	Satisfaction
1990s–2000s	Values-Driven	Emotional connection
2000s–2010s	Digital Era	Engagement
2010s–2020s	Data & AI Era	Personalization
2020s–Present	Marketing 6.0 Era Human + Tech	Experience



Marketing Strategy



Marketing strategy is a long-term plan focused on creating customer value and achieving competitive advantage by combining human understanding with advanced technology.



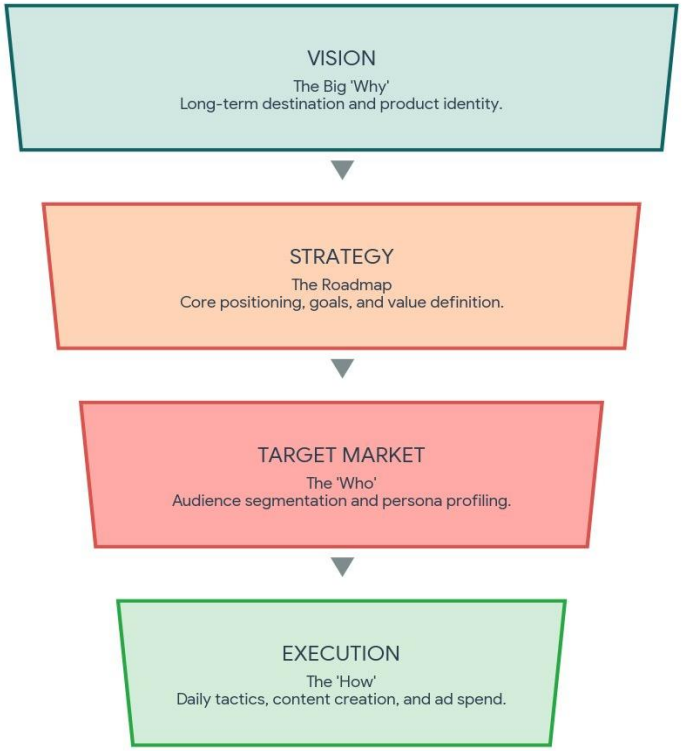
Marketing strategy focuses on using technology to deliver personalized, human-centered value to customers.

Marketing Strategy

An effective marketing strategy maps, high-level goals down to tactical activities. It ensures that every marketing campaign, budget allocation, and asset created directly supports the long-term vision of the company.

E.g.

- **Vision**: *"Become the safest cloud-storage platform for global finance firms"*
- **Strategy**: *"Position our brand around military-grade encryption and target mid-sized banks"*
- **Target Market**: *"Chief Information Security Officers at fintech companies with 50-500 employees"*
- **Execution**: *"Publish weekly whitepapers, run highly targeted LinkedIn ads, and attend regional banking cyber security expos"*



Marketing Mix

To build marketing strategy, businesses focus on aligning the **marketing mix**:

- **Product:** What you are selling and why it is valuable to the consumer.
- **Price:** Your pricing strategy in relation to market demand and competitors.
- **Place:** Where your product is being sold or distributed.
- **Promotion:** How you craft the message and which channels you use to reach your target audience.



Marketing Mix

McDonald's MARKETING MIX

Product



- Classic fast-food items like Big Mac, McNuggets, and fries
- Expanded menu with healthier options (salads, wraps, smoothies)
- Seasonal and limited-time offerings to keep interest high

Price



- Value pricing strategy for affordability
- Combo meals and value deals for cost suvings
- Frequent promotions, discounts, and coupons

Place



- 39,000+ restaurants in high-traffic global locations
- Presence in malls, airports, and busy streots

Promotion



- Iconic ad campaigns and catchy slogans (e.g., 'I'm Lovin' It'1)
- Targeted marketing for families, kids, and young adults

STP Model

- The STP Model (Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning) is a key marketing strategy framework.
- It helps businesses divide a broad market into smaller groups, select the most valuable groups to focus on, and create a clear, appealing message in the minds of those specific customers



Segmentation: Dividing the market into smaller groups based on demographics, behavior and preferences.
(Age / Gender/ Location)



Targeting: Selecting the most attractive customer segments based on profitability, needs and growth potential, Size, Accessibility



Positioning: Creating a unique image of the product in the customer's mind by focusing on value, experience and differentiation.

Customer Value Proposition



Customer Value Proposition (CVP) is the unique value a company offers to customers, explaining why they should choose its product or service over competitors.



It ensures a smooth and consistent customer journey across all touchpoints using data and technology.

Market Research



Market research is the process of collecting, analyzing, and interpreting data about customers, markets, and competitors to support better marketing decisions.



Market research uses data and advanced technology to understand customers and guide effective marketing decisions.

Market Research

- Market research is the process of gathering, analyzing, and interpreting information, typically about a target audience, market, or competitors. This information helps organizations understand what people need, want, think, and do—and why.

  - **Use of Primary and Secondary Data**
    Market research collects primary data (surveys and interviews) and secondary data (reports and databases) to understand customer needs, preferences, and behavior accurately.

  - **Data-Driven Decision Making**
    The insights gained from research help businesses make informed, customer-focused decisions, reduce uncertainty, and improve the effectiveness of marketing strategies.

Market Research with Digital Tools & AI

Digital research tools are online technologies used to collect and analyze customer data.

- Include tools like web analytics, social media insights, and online surveys.
- Help track customer behavior, preferences, and interactions in real time.
- Provide accurate and large-scale data for better decision-making.



Artificial Intelligence (AI) enhances market research by analyzing large datasets and predicting customer behavior.

- Identifies patterns and trends quickly.
- Enables predictive analytics and forecasting.
- Supports personalization and targeted marketing strategies.



Product Management



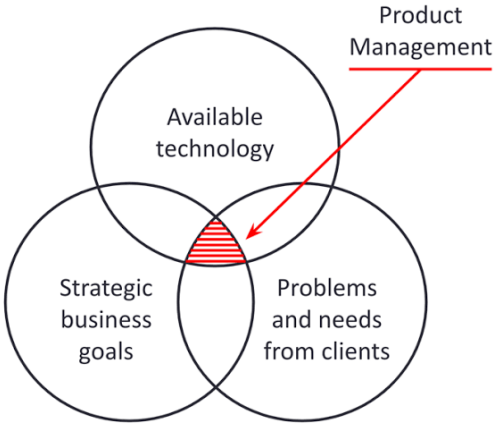
Product management is the process of planning, developing, and managing products to deliver value and meet evolving customer needs.



Product management uses technology and customer insights to continuously create and improve products that deliver value and better experiences.

Product Management

- Process of guiding a product from an initial idea to its final release and beyond.
  - **Does the customer need this?** (User Experience)
  - **Can we build this?** (Technology)
  - **Does this make sense for the business?** (Business Strategy)



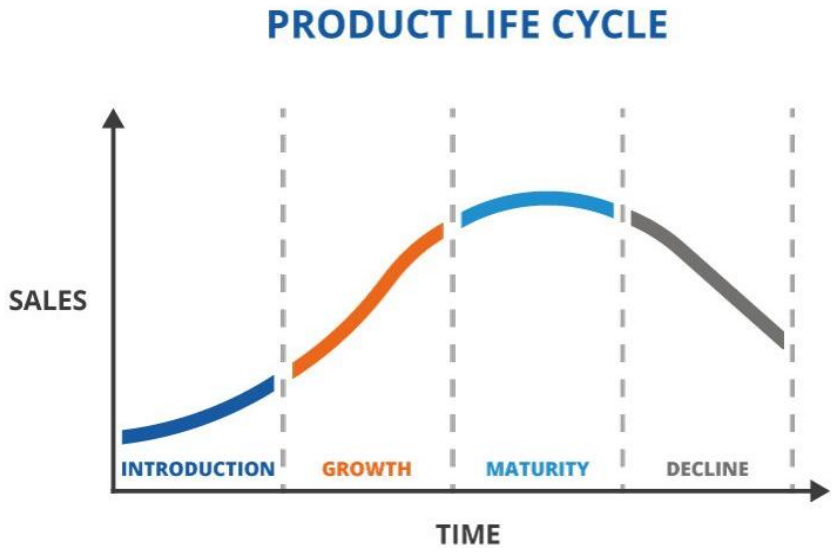
- Focuses on designing and developing products that effectively address real customer needs and provide meaningful value.
- Decisions are guided by customer data, feedback, and usage patterns to continuously improve product performance and relevance.
- Advanced technologies and innovative features are incorporated to enhance product functionality, usability, and user experience.
- Products are developed and improved through continuous testing, feedback, and updates using approaches such as Agile and Minimum Viable Product (MVP).

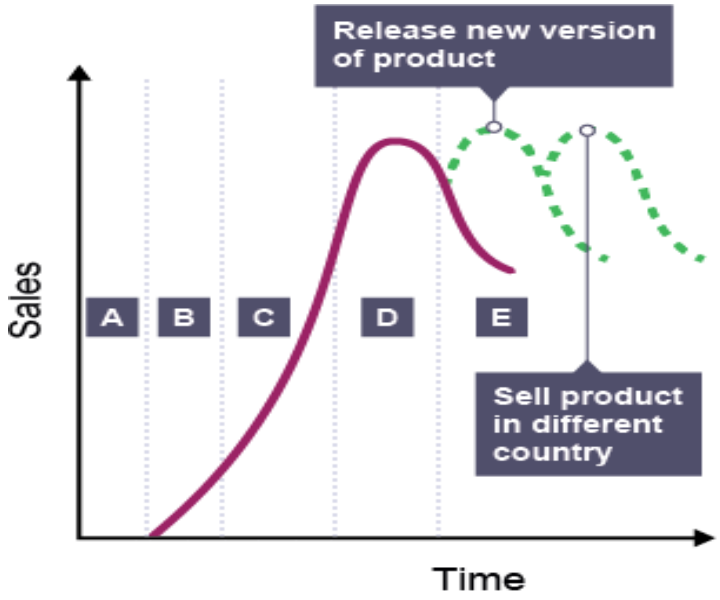
Product Life Cycle

The Product Life Cycle (PLC) describes the stages a product goes through from its introduction to its decline in the market.

Stages of the Product Life Cycle

1. **Introduction:** Product is launched and awareness is created.
2. **Growth:** Sales increase and the product gains popularity.
3. **Maturity:** Market becomes saturated and competition is high.
4. **Decline:** Sales decrease as demand reduces or new alternatives emerge.







Products in the IT Industry

In the IT industry, products are mainly digital solutions such as software, applications, and platforms designed to deliver continuous value and user experience.

- IT products include software-as-a-service (SaaS), mobile applications, and digital platforms that provide solutions and services to users through technology.
- These products are designed with a strong emphasis on usability, interface design, and overall user satisfaction to ensure a smooth and engaging experience.
- IT products are regularly updated and improved using customer feedback, usage data, and analytics to remain relevant and competitive.
- They support personalized features based on user behavior and integrate seamlessly with other systems and platforms to enhance functionality and convenience.



In Class Activity 1

Multiple Choice Question

What should be the first step before launching the product?

A. Advertising campaign

B. Market research

C. Pricing strategy

D. Product launch



Multiple Choice Question

Which strategy focuses on selecting the right customer group?

A. Positioning

B. Segmentation

C. Targeting

D. Branding



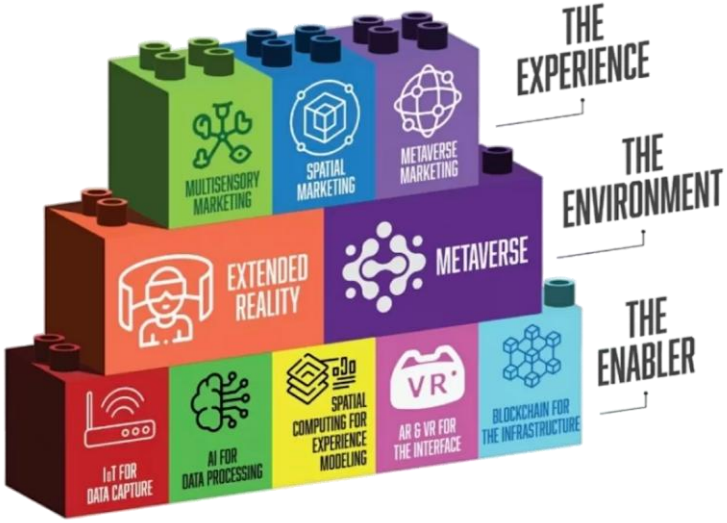
Short Answer Question

1. Why is market research important before developing a product?
2. What is one benefit of using Agile in product management?



Role of IT in Marketing 6.0

- Marketing 6.0 is the next stage of marketing evolution. It focuses on immersive, "phygital" (physical-plus-digital) experiences.
- In Marketing 6.0, IT enables companies to combine human understanding with advanced digital tools to create personalized, immersive, and meaningful customer experiences.





IT as an Enabler of Marketing 6.0

- **Data Collection and Analysis -** Collect customer data from websites, mobile apps and social media and run advanced analytics
- **Automation -** Predict customer needs, recommend products. Chatbots provide instant customer support.
- **Personalization -** Tailored content, offers and recommendations. Customers receive unique experiences.
- **Integration -** Connects multiple platforms such as websites, mobile apps, and physical stores. Customers experience consistent interactions across channels.
- **CRM-** Store and manage customer data. Enables long-term relationship building and loyalty.
- **Immersive Technologies -** Enables advanced experiences using AR, VR and meta verse where Customers can experience products virtually before buying.
- **Real-Time Decision Making -** Provide real-time insights. Businesses can quickly adjust and respond to customer behavior. Marketing becomes dynamic and responsive.
- **Enhanced Customer Experience (CX) -** Improves speed, convenience and accessibility. 24/7 services and instant communication. Higher customer satisfaction.



Digital Marketing



Digital marketing is the use of digital technologies and online platforms to promote products, engage customers, and deliver personalized experiences.



Digital marketing uses technology and data to create interactive, personalized, and customer-focused online experiences.

Digital Marketing Channels

- Digital marketing encompasses all marketing efforts that use electronic devices or the internet to connect with customers
  - Enables **two-way communication and real-time interaction** with customers.
  - Leverages **data and analytics** to target and personalize marketing efforts.
  - Focuses on creating **engaging and seamless digital experiences.**

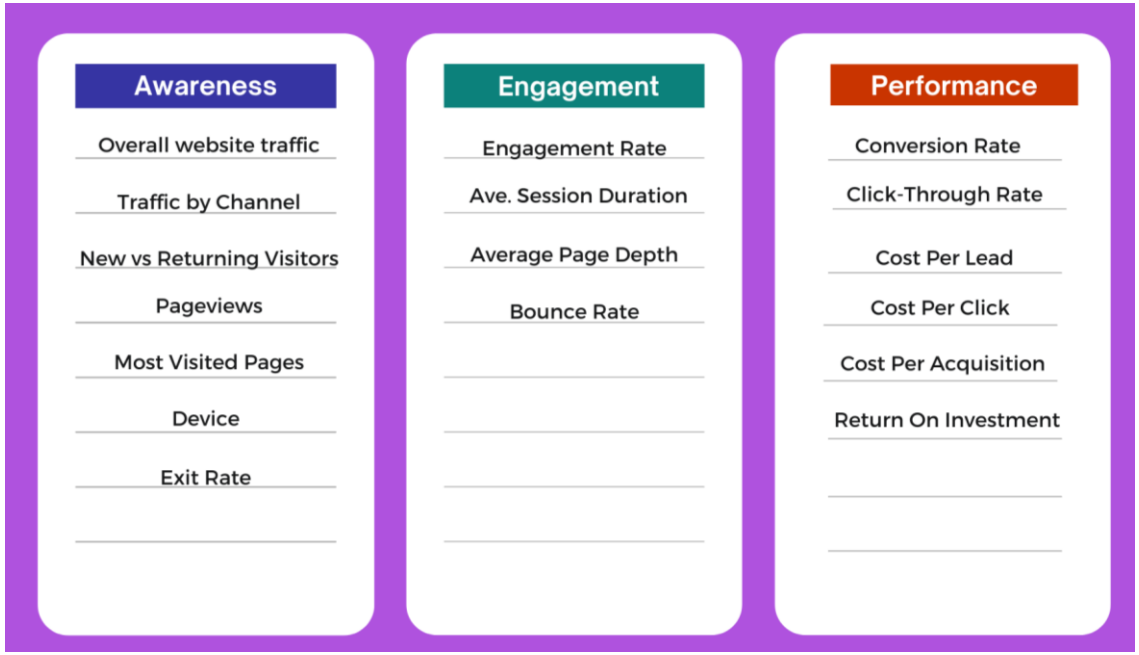
- Digital marketing channels are the online platforms and toolsthat businesses use to reach target audiences, promotebrands, and sell products or services. (websites, searchengines, social media, email, and paid advertisements)





Digital Metrics

- Digital marketing metrics are quantifiable data points used to track, measure, and evaluate the performance of online campaigns. They provide objective evidence of how audiences interact with your brand, helping businesses optimize strategies, allocate budgets, and improve Return on Investment (ROI).
- **Eg.**
  - **Click-through Rate (CTR)**
  - **Conversion Rate**
  - **Customer Acquisition Cost**



Brand Management



Brand management is the process of creating, maintaining, and enhancing a brand's identity, image, and value in the minds of customers.



Brand management focuses on using technology and experiences to build strong, meaningful, and lasting relationships with customers.



Brand Management

- **Building a Strong and Consistent Brand Identity**
  Brand management ensures that the brand's name, logo, message, and values are consistently communicated across all digital and physical channels to create a clear and recognizable identity.

- **Creating Emotional Connections and Trust**
  Brands focus on connecting with customers at an emotional level by aligning with their values, needs, and lifestyles, which helps build trust and long-term loyalty.

- **Use of Digital Platforms and Storytelling**
  Social media, websites, and digital content are used to share brand stories, engage customers, and create meaningful interactions that strengthen brand perception.

- **Enhancing Brand Equity through Experience**
  Positive and personalized customer experiences across all touchpoints increase the perceived value of the brand and differentiate it from competitors.

Brand Equity

- **Brand equity is the value a brand adds to a product or service based on customers' perceptions, trust, and experiences.**
- Built through **customer awareness, trust, and loyalty**.
- Influenced by **positive experiences and emotional connections**.
- Strengthened through **consistent branding across all channels.**







Experience-Driven Branding

- Experience-driven branding focuses on creating meaningful and memorable customer experiences to build strong brand relationships.
- Emphasizes customer experience at every touchpoint.
- Uses technology and personalization to enhance interactions.
- Builds emotional engagement and long-term loyalty.





In Class Activity 2

Multiple Choice Question

A clothing brand promotes its products using Instagram and influencer marketing.

Which type of marketing is being used?

A. Traditional marketing

B. Digital marketing

C. Direct selling

D. Personal selling



Short Answer Question

1. Give one advantage of digital marketing.
2. How does branding create customer loyalty?



Customer Relationship Management - CRM



Customer Relationship Management (CRM) is the process of managing and strengthening interactions with customers to build long-term relationships and loyalty.



CRM uses data and technology to build personalized, long-term relationships and enhance customer loyalty.



CRM Objectives

- **Customer Retention**

  Focus on keeping existing customers by providing consistent value and positive experiences.

- **Customer Loyalty**

  Build trust and emotional connection so customers continue to choose the brand over competitors.

- **Customer Lifetime Value (CLV)**

  Maximize the total value a customer brings over time through repeated purchases and engagement.

- **Personalized Customer Experience**

  Use data and technology to deliver tailored interactions and improve satisfaction.



CRM Tools

Digital systems and platforms used to manage customer data, interactions, and relationships effectively. CRM Tools are used to:

- Store and organize customer infor and interaction history
- Enable personalized communication and targeted marketing
- Support automation of marketing, sales, and customer service tasks
- Provide data analytics and insights for better decision-making

CRM Tools - Examples

Salesforce

- A leading cloud-based CRM platform used by large organizations.
- Helps manage **customer data, sales processes, and marketing campaigns.**
- Provides **advanced analytics, AI (Einstein), and automation.**
- Used for **large-scale, data-driven customer relationship management.**



CRM Tools - Examples

HubSpot

- A user-friendly CRM platform popular among small and medium businesses
- Offers tools for **marketing, sales, and customer service in one system**
- Includes **email marketing, lead tracking, and automation features**
- Known for **ease of use and inbound marketing capabilities**



CRM Tools - Examples

Zoho CRM

- A cost-effective CRM solution suitable for startups and SMEs
- Helps manage **sales pipelines, customer interactions, and workflows**
- Provides **automation, analytics, and integration with other Zoho apps**
- Ideal for **affordable and customizable CRM solutions**





In Class Activity 3

Multiple Choice Question

An online store sends personalized emails and offers based on customer purchase history.

What concept is demonstrated here?

A. Market segmentation

B. CRM

C. Product development

D. Pricing strategy



Multiple Choice Question

What is the main goal of CRM?

A. Increase production

B. Reduce employees

C. Build long-term customer relationships

D. Focus only on new customers



Short Answer Question

1. What is one benefit of personalized communication in CRM?
2. Name one CRM tool used by companies.



Customer Experience (CX)

Customer Experience (CX) refers to the overall perception and feelings a customer has from all interactions with a brand across different touchpoints.



Customer Experience (CX)

- **Covers Every Customer Interaction**

  Customer experience includes all interactions a customer has with a brand, from initial awareness and consideration to purchase and post-purchase support, shaping their overall perception.

- **Seamless and Consistent Experience Across Channels**

  Businesses ensure that customers receive a smooth and unified experience across all touchpoints such as websites, mobile apps, social media, and physical stores.

- **Combination of Functional, Emotional, and Digital Experiences**

  CX is created by delivering not only product functionality and service quality but also emotional satisfaction and engaging digital interactions.

- **Enhanced Through Data, Personalization, and Technology**

  Companies use customer data, analytics, and technologies like AI to personalize interactions, predict needs, and continuously improve the overall customer experience.